

Early Composition

put your ideas on paper

For Alexander & Nicolas · Outdoor Fun series

Start Here

Composition means putting your own ideas into words on paper. It starts small — one sentence — and grows into whole stories. You don't need fancy words or perfect spelling to be a writer. You just need an idea and a place to put it. (A grown-up can scribe for you, too.)

A writer is just someone with an idea and a place to put it. That's you.

Building Up

From one sentence to a whole story. Take it in steps.

🗨️ One Good Sentence

Start with a single sentence about anything.

JUST STARTING

1. Think of one thing you did or like.
2. Say it in one sentence out loud.
3. Write it down (or a grown-up writes it as you say it).

GOING SOLO

1. Make your sentence longer with a 'because' or 'and'.
2. Add a describing word.
3. Write two sentences that go together.

One sentence is real writing. I started!

► **Watch: writing sentences — search on YouTube**

*Tell Me About Your Day

Easy writing from real life.

JUST STARTING

1. Pick one thing from today.
2. Tell it: first this, then that.
3. Write or dictate two or three sentences.

GOING SOLO

1. Add how you felt about it.
2. Put events in order with 'first, next, last'.
3. Add a detail only you would know.

My day is a great story. I lived it!

► **Watch: daily journal kids — search on YouTube**

Tiny Stories

Make up a little story with a start, middle, and end.

JUST STARTING

1. Pick a character (real or made-up).
2. Say what they want.
3. Tell what happens — start, middle, end.

GOING SOLO

1. Add a problem and how it's solved.
2. Add describing words and feelings.
3. Write a story about your Drawing-app character.

I can make up a whole story. I'm the author!

► **Watch: writing tiny stories — search on YouTube**

My Story

A picture story you can read together, or anytime.

I Am an Author

A story about writing my ideas

PAGE 1

Today I write my own ideas. I am an author.

PAGE 2

I start with one good sentence. That's real writing.

PAGE 3

I write about my day — first this, then that.

PAGE 4

I make up a tiny story with a start, middle, and end.

PAGE 5

A grown-up can write my words while I say them. That counts!

PAGE 6

My spelling doesn't have to be perfect. My ideas matter most.

PAGE 7

I have ideas, and now they live on paper.

For Grown-Ups

For grown-ups supporting early writing.

Scribing counts

Let the child compose orally while you write — separating *having ideas* from the motor and spelling load frees the imagination and shows them their words matter. Transcribe faithfully, including their voice.

Ideas before mechanics

Don't let spelling or neatness gate the writing. Celebrate the idea first; tidy mechanics later (or not at all, for a first draft). 'One good sentence' is a complete, praiseworthy success.

Build the staircase, cross-link

Sentence → day-recount → tiny story is a gentle progression. Tie it to the Drawing app (write about your character) and Reading Comprehension (story shape). Keep it short and choice-rich.